SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

# SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-20 Tuesday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply-Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source **SMM / SGX**

## Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

**SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract** Latest price
**91.05**
USD/dmt
FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX
As of preparation: 2026-10-20 17:56:12 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 10-20 17:38:06 (UTC+8)
Last 3 months

**DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701** Daily
**681.5**
yuan/mt
▼ -1.0 -0.15%
MTD avg **678.6**
As of Oct 20 · vs Oct 19
Last 3 months

## SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Oct 20

**MMi 61% Port Spot** Daily
**660**
yuan/wmt
▼ -1 -0.15%
MTD avg **659**
Last 3 months

**MMi 58% Port Spot** Daily
**616**
yuan/wmt
▼ -1 -0.16%
MTD avg **619**
Last 3 months

**MMi 65% Port Spot** Daily
**819**
yuan/wmt
▼ -1 -0.12%
MTD avg **821**
Last 3 months

**MMi 61% Seaborne Index** Daily
**90.50**
USD/dmt
▼ -0.40 -0.44%
MTD avg **90.59**
Last 3 months

**MMi 65% Seaborne Index** Daily
**107.75**
USD/dmt
▼ -0.20 -0.19%
MTD avg **109.27**
Last 3 months

**SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index** Daily
**796.81**
yuan/mt
▼ -24.77 -3.01%
MTD avg **818.50**
As of Oct 16 · vs Oct 15
Last 3 months

## Key View

### Rebound momentum eases as port and seaborne prices pull back; demand support still needs to strengthen

**After the previous broad gains, prices pulled back modestly, highlighting the fragility of the recovery.** DCE most-traded closed at 681.5 yuan/mt, down 0.15%. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 660, 616 and 819 yuan/wmt, each down 1 yuan. The seaborne 61% index eased to USD 90.50/dmt and the 65% to 107.75, with 11 brands lower and one unchanged. Trader activity was reasonable, but mills continued restocking mainly for immediate needs, leaving price recovery without sustained transaction support.

Supply and cost conditions still offer some cushion. Latest arrivals in China declined, some Tangshan concentrates remained tight and the period's import margins improved. However, lower flows do not immediately absorb port stocks, and profitability in import trading is not a substitute for steelmaking margins. Divergent C3 and C5 freight movements also show that cost improvements are not uniform across resources.

**The key near-term question is whether buying moves beyond immediate requirements into sustained restocking.** Limited improvement in end-user orders and finished-steel margins could leave inventories constraining upside; stronger transactions and mill production would provide a firmer basis for recovery. A range-bound view remains appropriate, with attention on how trading, collections and profitability develop together rather than on a single session's price move.

## Today's Highlights

- **Futures eased as the previous recovery lost momentum.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **681.5 yuan/mt**, down 1.0 yuan (-0.15%) from Oct 19. Qingdao PB Fines were 647 yuan/wmt (-1), Newman Fines 647 (-4) and Mac Fines 654 (+1), showing mixed spot performance.
- **Seaborne indices pulled back and most brands softened.** The 61% index was **USD 90.50/dmt**, down 0.40 (-0.44%), and the 65% was **107.75**, down 0.20 (-0.19%). Eleven of the 12 brands declined against the Oct 19 report and one was unchanged; PB Fines were 90.85, Newman Fines 89.95 and Mac Fines 90.25 USD/dmt.
- **All three port indices fell by 1 yuan.** The 61%, 58% and 65% port spot indices were 660, 616 and 819 yuan/wmt. The 65%-58% port spread held at 203 yuan/wmt, while the seaborne 65%-61% spread widened from USD 17.05 to 17.25/dmt.
- **Purchases remained needs-based, with the demand response still in focus.** SMM reported reasonable trader activity, needs-based mill restocking and limited overall transactions. The imported ore margin assessment published Oct 20 put the period's average at 11.52 yuan/mt, above 6.38 previously, but better trading margins do not establish that mills have returned to profit.

## Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

| Product | 10-20 (yuan/wmt) | Daily change / % | MTD avg | Last 12 months |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **PB Fines** 60.8% Daily | 647 | ▼ -1 -0.15% | 646 | |
| **Newman Fines** 61.2% Daily | 647 | ▼ -4 -0.61% | 649 | * |
| **Mac Fines** 60.8% Daily | 654 | ▲ +1 +0.15% | 650 | |
| **BRBF** 62.5% Daily | 702 | ▼ -1 -0.14% | 698 | |
| **Newman Lump** 63% Daily | 837 | ▼ -1 -0.12% | 840 | |
| **Super Special Fines (SSF)** 56.5% Daily | 509 | ▼ -1 -0.20% | 508 | |
| **Carajas Fines (IOCJ)** 65% Daily | 822 | ▼ -1 -0.12% | 826 | |
| **PB Lump** 61.5% Daily | 832 | ▼ -1 -0.12% | 834 | * |

## Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

### Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

| Product | 10-20 (USD/dmt) | Daily change / % | 10-19 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Roy Hill Fines** 62% Daily | 87.40 | ▼ -0.35 -0.40% | 87.75 |
| **SIMEC Fines** 61% Daily | 89.10 | ▼ -0.35 -0.39% | 89.45 |
| **PB Fines** 62% Daily | 90.85 | ▼ -0.40 -0.44% | 91.25 |
| **Newman Fines** 60.7% Daily | 89.95 | ▼ -0.40 -0.44% | 90.35 |
| **Mac Fines** 60.5% Daily | 90.25 | ▼ -0.40 -0.44% | 90.65 |
| **Jimblebar Fines** 60.30% Daily | 87.15 | ▼ -0.40 -0.46% | 87.55 |
| **Carajas Fines (IOCJ)** 65% Daily | 107.30 | ▼ -0.10 -0.09% | 107.40 |
| **SSFT / SSFG** 60% Daily | 97.80 | — 0.00 0.00% | 97.80 |
| **Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF)** 64% Daily | 97.35 | ▼ -0.15 -0.15% | 97.50 |
| **RTX Fines** 61% Daily | 86.05 | ▼ -0.40 -0.46% | 86.45 |
| **West Pilbara Fines (WPF)** 60% Daily | 90.50 | ▼ -0.35 -0.39% | 90.85 |
| **SP10 Fines** 59%-60% Daily | 79.90 | ▼ -0.40 -0.50% | 80.30 |

### SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

| Index | Month-to-date avg | MoM | YTD | Unit | Last 12 months |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index** Daily | 90.59 | -6.14% | -14.6% | USD/dmt | |
| **SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index** Daily | 109.27 | -4.51% | -11.2% | USD/dmt | |
| **SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index** Daily | 659 | -4.76% | -18.8% | yuan/wmt | |
| **SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index** Daily | 821 | -2.23% | -8.9% | yuan/wmt | |
| **SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index** Daily | 619 | -4.33% | -14.2% | yuan/wmt | |
| **SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index** Daily | 818.50 | -2.39% | -10.1% | yuan/mt | |

The seaborne 61% index was USD 90.50/dmt (-0.44%) and the 65% was 107.75 (-0.19%), widening their spread from USD 17.05 to 17.25/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 660, 616 and 819 yuan/wmt, each down 1 yuan.

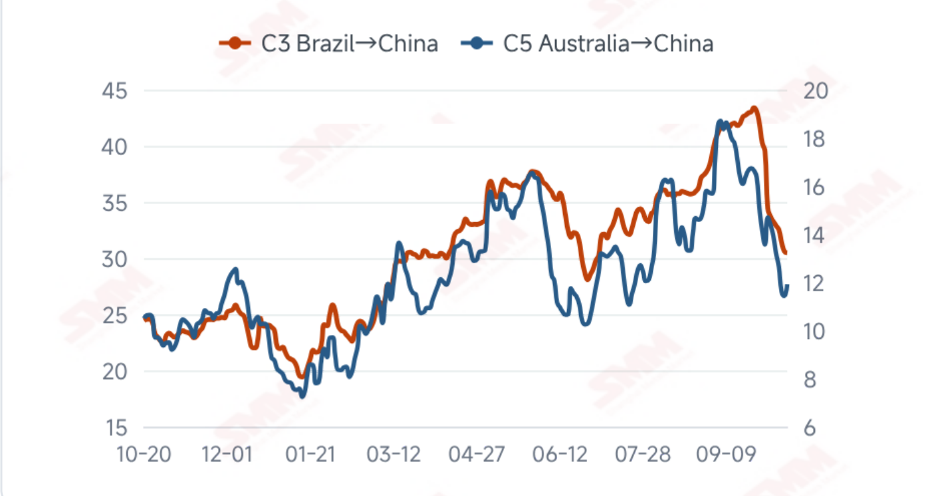
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

## Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

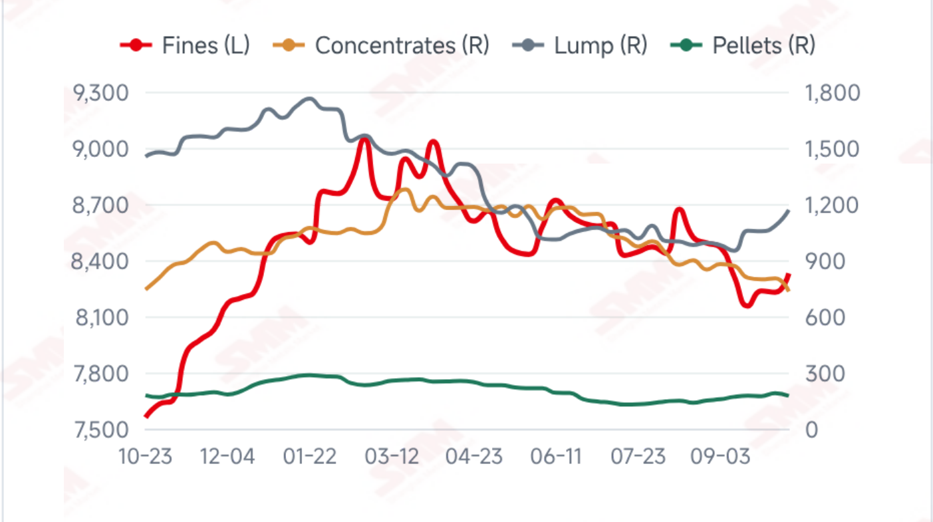
### Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



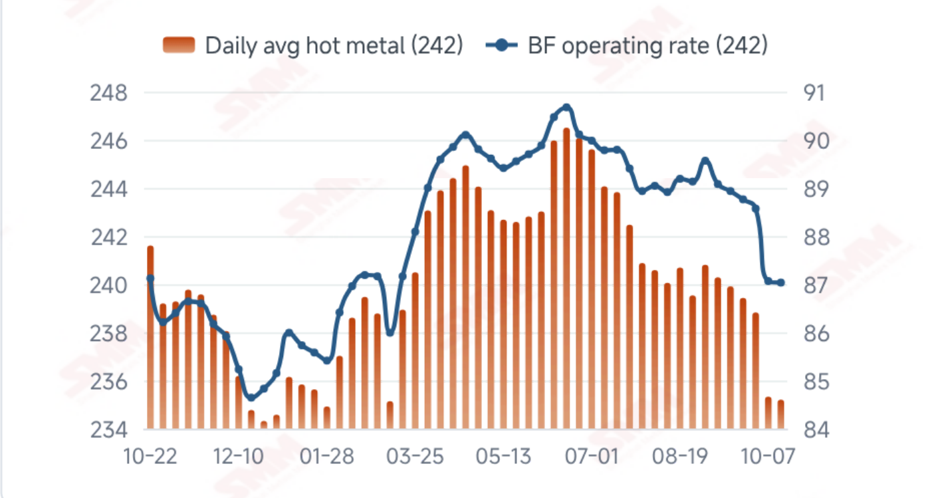
### Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



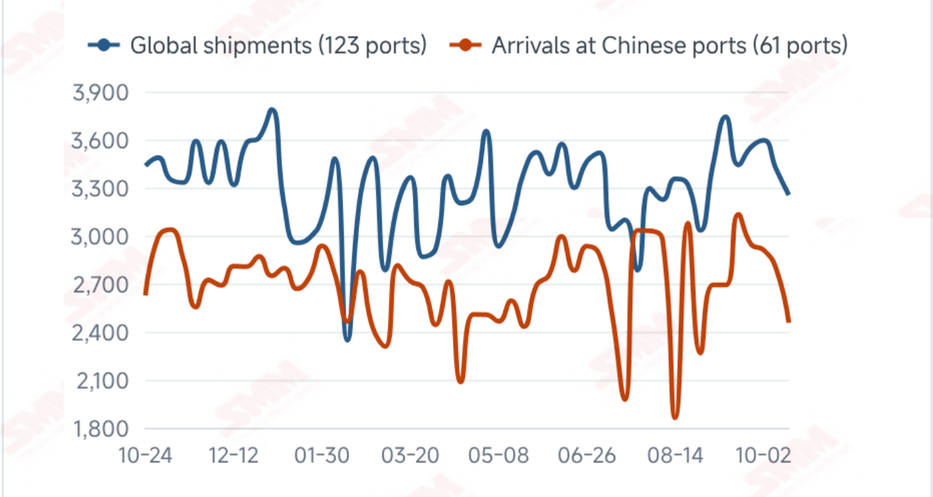
### Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



### Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



## Market Commentary · Imported Ore

| | |
|---|---|
| **Futures & spot** | DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 681.5 yuan/mt, down 0.15% from Oct 19. Qingdao PB Fines were 647, BRBF 702, Newman Lump 837, SSF 509, Carajas Fines 822 and PB Lump 832 yuan/wmt, each down 1 yuan. Newman Fines fell 4 yuan to 647, while Mac Fines rose 1 yuan to 654. SMM reported needs-based restocking and limited transactions. SGX official current-month FEFV26 was last priced at USD 91.05/dmt, timestamped Oct 20, 17:38:06 (UTC+8). |
| **Drivers** | Following the previous session's broad gains, the rebound lost some momentum. Both seaborne indices eased and all three port indices edged lower, indicating that demand support still requires more persistent transactions. Differences between brand prices may reflect available material and blending choices rather than a change in aggregate demand. Continued control of raw-material stocks by mills could limit the scope for a recovery. |
| **Demand** | SMM's current coke briefing described needs-based mill purchases, with neither concentrated restocking nor large-scale production cuts. The latest available 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3520 million mt on Oct 14 and a blast furnace operating rate of 87.03%. Cost relief may improve operating conditions at some mills, but sustained ore purchases still depend on end-user orders, finished-steel selling prices and the extent of margin repair. |
| **Inventory & supply** | Global shipments were 32.5276 million mt in the week to Oct 16, down 4.72% WoW, while arrivals in China were 24.5464 million mt, down 12.07%. Australia shipped 18.6396 million mt and Brazil 7.9581 million mt, with differing trends across origins. The latest ten-port inventory was 104.0212 million mt on Oct 15, up 1.0047 million mt from Sep 30. Lower arrivals coexist with substantial existing stocks, so mill collection rates remain important; falling flows alone do not establish tighter spot availability. |
| **Cost & margin** | SMM's imported ore cost-and-margin table published Oct 20 put the period's average margin at 11.52 yuan/mt, up 5.14 yuan from 6.38. This measures import trading, not mill profitability after the current session's close. Oct 19 freight was USD 30.46/mt for C3, down 0.46% from the previous reading, and 11.91 for C5, up 4.29%. Route-specific costs moved differently, and actual returns also depend on contracts, selling prices and exchange rates. Losses at coke producers coexist with controlled mill buying, leaving subsequent coke pricing dependent on negotiations. |

## Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

| | |
|---|---|
| **Prices** | SMM's Oct 20 Tangshan brief quoted 66% concentrate at 880–885 yuan/mt on a dry-basis, tax-inclusive ex-works basis, with prices relatively stable. The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 796.81 yuan/mt on Oct 16; grade and pricing terms distinguish the regional quotation from the national measure. |
| **Supply & demand** | Resources at Tangshan miners and beneficiation plants remained tight, and earlier price declines improved the relative value of some concentrates, potentially supporting offers. However, clear mill losses continued to sustain pressure on bids. The persistence of purchasing recovery needs to be assessed against actual transactions and profitability. |
| **Outlook** | SMM expects limited room for a modest recovery in Tangshan concentrate prices. This is an outlook rather than evidence of a price increase today; continued needs-based mill buying could constrain the extent of any rise. |

## Market Factors

### ▲ Supportive factors

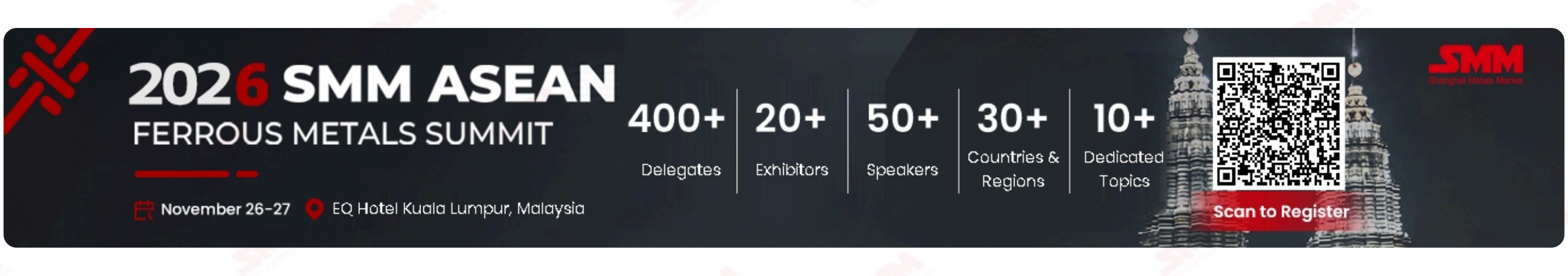
- Latest arrivals in China fell 12.07% WoW.
- Some domestic concentrate resources remained tight, with relative value improving from earlier levels.
- The period's average import margin expanded to 11.52 yuan/mt.
- Needs-based mill purchases continued to provide a baseline of demand.

### ▼ Bearish factors

- DCE and all five MMi indices eased this period.
- Eleven of the 12 seaborne brands declined, reversing the previous upward pattern.
- Overall transactions remained limited without concentrated restocking.
- Substantial port stocks and constraints on mill profitability may limit upside.

## Flash News

- BHP holds guidance as iron ore rebound loses steam [SMM Iron Ore] ↗
  2026-10-20
- [Brief Review of Chinese Iron Ore] Iron ore concentrate prices in the Tangshan area may have limited room to edge higher ↗
  2026-10-20
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261020 ↗
  2026-10-20
- [SMM Steel] Indonesian Wire Rod Holds at $500/mt FOB, but Buyers Push for Cuts in Line with Chinese Offers ↗
  2026-10-20
- [SMM Steel] Turkish Rebar: Weak Domestic Intake Drives Prices Down, Export FOB Holds Flat in Wait-and-See Mode ↗
  2026-10-20
- [SMM Steel] Vietnam HRC Import Offers Decline as Buyers Remain Cautious ↗
  2026-10-20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